

Implant reviews: ongoing care

Care continues after implant surgery and delivery of your dental restoration. Regular reviews help us identify changes early, address potential damage and support the long-term health of your implant restoration.

Your surgeon and general dentist work together

We review implants placed surgically in our practice and subsequently restored by your general dentist. We assess bone, soft tissues and the complete implant-supported construction. Your general dentist remains responsible for the restoration and ongoing dental prevention and cleaning.

Our review schedule

First two years: annually

We arrange an annual surgical implant review during the first two years. The dates are agreed with you, taking the timing of surgery and delivery of the restoration into account.

After a stable two-year period

If conditions remain stable for two years, we may extend the intervals between surgical reviews. Your next appointment is agreed individually.

Regular care remains necessary after two years. Supportive maintenance and checks with your general dentist continue long term. Their frequency depends on inflammation risk, cleaning and clinical findings; higher-risk patients need shorter intervals.

Why attend when nothing hurts?

Inflammation and mechanical changes may initially go unnoticed. Inflammation of the soft tissues around an implant is called **peri-implant mucositis**. If supporting bone is also progressively lost, this is **peri-implantitis**. Early soft-tissue inflammation can often be treated effectively. More advanced disease needs further treatment.

A screw connection can also loosen before significant discomfort develops. Regular appointments help detect these changes; they cannot guarantee a permanently trouble-free result.

Before your appointment

Please bring your implant passport, current medication list and, if applicable, your night guard. We can request existing X-rays and details of the restoration from your general dentist. New illnesses, smoking, diabetes, previous periodontitis and difficulties cleaning are relevant to planning your care.

Your checklist

Implant passport and medication list up to date? Suitable cleaning aids? Symptoms discussed? Next surgical review and ongoing maintenance with your general dentist arranged?

What we assess at your implant review

Bone and changes over time

Bone conditions and changes compared with previous findings. Suitable X-rays supplement the examination when a specific question needs answering.

Soft tissues and scars

Colour, swelling, bleeding, pus, tissue quality and gum recession. We check that scars are settled and look for pulling or pressure areas.

Hygiene and access for cleaning

Plaque, trapped food and access beneath crowns, bridges and dentures. We check whether the recommended cleaning aids work for your restoration.

Construction and function

Secure seating of the restoration, its connections, visible damage and wear. Bite contacts, tooth grinding and possible excess cement are also considered.

Measurements help us identify changes

We gently examine the tissues around each implant with a fine probe, ideally at six sites. We record pocket depths, bleeding and any pus. Comparison with earlier values is particularly useful: one deep measurement alone does not establish disease.

A baseline examination after completion of the restoration helps with later reviews. If earlier records or images are missing, we try to obtain them and establish a documented current assessment.

When are X-rays needed?

A suitable reference image documents bone levels. Further images need an individual indication, for example increasing pocket depths together with bleeding or pus. A targeted two-dimensional image is often sufficient. **CBCT is not a routine part of every implant review.**

What does looseness mean?

A moving crown or bridge may indicate a loose prosthetic or abutment screw. This differs from an implant that moves within the bone. We establish which part is affected and coordinate any necessary care with your general dentist.

Continuing to load a loose connection may cause repeated movement, wear or abrasion and damage to the screw or connection. Fracture and later fitting problems are possible. **Please have clicking or movement checked promptly.**

A restoration that appears normal is not automatically dismantled or routinely retightened. A firm restoration alone does not rule out inflammation.

What are the costs?

The extent of examination, cleaning, imaging or repair depends on your findings. We explain necessary services, any private charges and reimbursement questions in advance. No general price or insurance-coverage guarantee is given here.

What happens after the review?

- **Stable findings:** discuss cleaning and arrange your next surgical review and dental maintenance appointment.
- **Soft-tissue inflammation:** arrange professional plaque removal, improve home cleaning and reassess. Poor access may require an adjustment to the restoration.
- **Suspected peri-implantitis:** complete the necessary investigations and discuss a separate treatment plan.
- **Looseness or damage:** identify the cause and coordinate restorative or surgical care with the relevant practice.

What you can do

Clean your teeth and implants daily, including between them and beneath the restoration, using aids selected for you. Ask for a demonstration. Maintain good diabetes control and avoid smoking. A custom night guard may help if you grind your teeth. Mouthwash does not replace mechanical cleaning.

Frequently asked questions

Does the examination hurt or require anaesthesia?

A routine review does not require anaesthesia. Gentle probing may briefly feel uncomfortable or cause bleeding at inflamed sites. If further treatment is needed, its procedure and any anaesthesia will be discussed separately.

Is the review the same as professional cleaning?

No. The review assesses your condition and identifies the next steps. Regular supportive cleaning is a separate part of your care, coordinated with your general dentist.

Warning signs and contact

Please arrange a prompt appointment for bleeding during cleaning, pus, a new unpleasant taste, swelling, pain or a change in your bite. If something moves, avoid chewing on it, do not tighten or glue it yourself and do not wait until your next scheduled review.

Practice: **06151 786540**. Following a procedure, outside practice hours: **+49 151 10437450**. If unavailable: emergency dental service **01805 60 70 11**.

For a life-threatening emergency, breathing difficulty, severe difficulty swallowing or rapidly increasing swelling of the floor of the mouth, neck or tongue: **112**.

Clinical background: MKG im Carree practice protocol; [EFP S3-Leitlinie / clinical practice guideline, 2023](#); [World Workshop: peri-implant diseases and conditions, 2018](#); [ITI: implant-supported fixed prostheses, technical complications and maintenance](#). Accessed 09 September 2026. This information supplements your individual consultation.